

Shark Tank Pitch Report: KisanSetu

7/10/2026 · Decision: **Invest** · Overall 79/100

Pitch

Ask: ₹50 lakh

Problem: Millions of farmers across India are eligible to sell at the government's MSP, but many can't use it in practice. They wait days for their turn at the procurement centre, and their work at home stops while they wait. Some middlemen and staff ask for money per quintal to move a farmer's turn forward, so those who don't pay wait longer. Government payment takes about a month, but farmers need cash right away for daily expenses and the next season's crop. So they sell to local buyers at lower prices and lose the MSP benefit. I am a farmer's son and have seen this happen first-hand.

Solution: A mobile-first platform that lets farmers sell grains and produce directly to government procurement at MSP, with no third party in between. Farmers book a time slot online, so there are no long queues and no paying to jump the line. Slots are given in order of booking, and a farmer can see their status on the app. The platform also tracks each farmer's sale limit and payment status, and can offer an optional advance against the confirmed sale, so farmers get cash on time while the government payment is pending. We will start with a pilot in one district and one crop, then scale across India.

Revenue model: A small transaction fee (about 0.5–1% of sale value) charged only on completed sales, not on the farmer's signup. Interest or a service fee on the optional advance, funded by a lending partner (NBFC or bank). We would earn a share of this. A subscription or licensing fee from state agencies, mandis and FPOs for using the slot-booking and tracking system.

Audience: Small and marginal farmers across India who sell wheat, paddy and other MSP crops. Our first 1,000 customers will be farmers around one procurement district. Later we will add FPOs, mandis and state procurement agencies.

Scores

Market potential	75/100
Innovation	75/100
Business model	84/100
Execution	75/100
Investment worthiness	85/100

Deal

Valuation: ₹4.17 Cr · Funding/offer: ₹50 L · Equity: 12%

KisanSetu scores 79/100. Strongest area: investment worthiness (85). The sharks back the plan at ₹50 L for 12% equity, implying a valuation near ₹4.17 Cr. Watch execution (75).

Judges' verdicts

The Venture Capitalist: in (75/100)

The Founder: in (75/100)

The Customer: in (75/100)

The Angel Investor: in (84/100)

Q&A

The Venture Capitalist: How big can KisanSetu really get? Give me the market size and why this scales 10x.

The money flowing through MSP buying is already huge. MSP payouts for foodgrains reached ₹3.33 lakh crore between July 2024 and June 2025, on about 1,175 lakh tonnes of procurement. Two examples show how many farmers are involved: pib In wheat alone, 21.03 lakh farmers had been paid about ₹62,156 crore by April 30 of the 2025-26 season. tribuneindia For paddy in 2025-26, India procured 835 lakh tonnes worth about ₹1.99 lakh crore. kashmirilife Telangana alone benefited 13.97 lakh farmers in one kharif season. siasat At our planned fee of 0.5-1% on completed sales, the ceiling on the ₹3.33 lakh crore flow is roughly ₹1,665-3,330 crore a year. That is the theoretical maximum, not a forecast. A more realistic picture: 5% of that flow (about ₹16,650 crore) at a 0.75% fee would give about ₹125 crore in annual revenue. Treat this as an illustration of the opportunity, not a promise. Why it scales 10x Pilot to state to national. The booking, tracking and sale-limit system is software, so a new district costs us little more than onboarding farmers and the local agency. Start with one district and one crop, then move to a full state, then to other states. More revenue per farmer over time. We start with the sale fee. Next we add the optional advance with a lending partner, and then paid licences for state agencies and FPOs. More crops. The same system works for wheat, paddy, pulses and oilseeds. Network effect. More farmers on the platform means better queue data for agencies, and agencies that adopt it bring in more farmers. What to expect from the sharks Official reports say MSP payment is made within 24 to 48 hours in most cases, but you saw about a month. Don't ignore this, because a shark may raise it. Answer with your own experience and say honestly that it varies by state, district and crop. Also point out that the advance feature and the slot booking solve the queue and "pay to jump the line" problems either way. A short pilot with local farmers that records their real wait and payment times would be your best evidence.

The Founder: Who is on the KisanSetu team, and what have you actually built or shipped so far?

"I'm the founder, and I'm a farmer's son, so I've seen this problem myself. I've watched farmers wait in long queues, and I've heard about people paying money per quintal to move their turn forward. On the technical side, I work in Python, machine learning, SQL and web development, and I use Git and GitHub for my projects. I'm Vice Chair of ACM at ABES and Technical Head of Unnat Bharat Abhiyan, where I work on rural-focused technical projects. So far, I've completed [customer and MVP blueprint / validation report], which maps the farmer's problem, the slot-booking flow and the first features. I have [number] conversations with farmers, and the main things I learned were [finding]. [If true: I've built a prototype of the slot-booking and sale-limit tracker.] I'm now looking for [an advisor / a co-founder with procurement or agency experience / an NBFC partner] to join us. With this funding, the first step is a pilot in one district with one crop, so I can show real wait times, real bookings and real farmer feedback." Where the brackets matter The Founder shark wants proof of execution, and the answer scores best with specifics like numbers and things you've actually done. These are the strongest things you can add, roughly in order: Farmer conversations: talk to 10-20 farmers, and write down their wait times and how long payment took. A working prototype: even a simple booking page you can demo counts. An advisor or co-founder: someone from agriculture, a mandi, an FPO or finance would fill the gap in your team. Don't claim a team or product you don't have, because the sharks will question

it. Saying "I'm a solo founder at an early stage and here is exactly who I'm adding" is a more credible answer.

The Customer: Would I use KisanSetu every week? What do I stop doing once I have it?

"Not every week all year, and I won't pretend otherwise. Government buying happens in seasons, wheat in spring and paddy in autumn. During those weeks, a farmer would use KisanSetu several times a week: to book a slot, check their turn, track their sale limit and see when payment arrives. Once they have it, a farmer stops: Standing in queues for days while the work at home stops. Paying extra per quintal to move their turn forward. Travelling to the centre again and again just to find out where they are in line. Selling to a local buyer at a lower price only because they need cash now. The optional advance against a confirmed sale is meant to fix this. To keep farmers coming back outside the season, we add things they need all year: MSP price alerts, crop-wise sale limits and reminders, and planning for the next season. That turns a seasonal tool into a regular one." Where to be careful The advance and off-season features are plans, not products you've built yet. Say "we will add" and not "we have". If you can get even a few farmers to say they would use the app, add that. For example: "Out of [number] farmers I spoke to, [number] said they would book a slot."

The Angel Investor: What does it cost to win one customer, and what does one customer pay you over time?

"Our estimates are based on the reported numbers, and the pilot will test them. In wheat, about 21 lakh farmers were paid roughly ₹62,000 crore this season, which is around ₹2.9 lakh per farmer. In Telangana's paddy, 13.97 lakh farmers were paid about ₹16,900 crore, around ₹1.2 lakh per farmer. These averages lean towards larger farmers, so for planning I'm assuming a much lower average sale of ₹1 lakh per farmer per season. What one customer pays us: at a 0.5-1% fee on a ₹1 lakh sale, that is ₹500-1,000 per season. If a farmer sells two crops a year, it's ₹1,000-2,000 a year. If they take the optional advance, we earn an extra service share on top. What it costs to win one customer: I'm targeting ₹150-300 per farmer. We will reach farmers through village-level agents, FPOs, common service centres and student volunteers from groups like NSS and UBA, who already work in rural areas. The cost covers a small incentive per farmer who completes a first booking, plus a demo and printed material. At a conservative ₹300 cost per farmer and ₹500 earned per season, we get our money back in the first season. If a farmer stays for three seasons, that is about ₹1,500 in lifetime value, or 5 times the acquisition cost. The pilot will measure the real numbers." Weak spots to prepare for Will farmers pay a fee? They are price-sensitive. Have a fallback ready: if farmers won't pay, the state agency or mandi pays through a licence, as in the revenue model. Fee limits: check whether charging a fee on a government-MSP sale is allowed in your state before you promise it. Revenue is seasonal. Most of it arrives in a few months of the year.

The Venture Capitalist: What stops a bigger player from copying KisanSetu next quarter? What is your moat?

"A bigger player can copy the app, but not what sits behind it. We plan to build our moat in four layers: Trust with farmers. Farmers don't adopt a tool because it exists; they adopt it when someone they know recommends it. I'm a farmer's son, and I'm already connected to rural outreach through UBA and NSS. A large company has to build that village-level trust from nothing. Integration with procurement agencies. Once a state agency or mandi runs its slot allocation on KisanSetu, switching means retraining staff and changing processes. Each district we integrate makes us harder to replace. Data nobody else has. Wait times by centre, peak days and crop-wise sale limits help agencies plan better. That data only builds up from running real pilots. Focus. A large firm treats this as one small feature. We treat it as our whole business and will fix problems faster. We aren't going to out-spend a bigger player. We plan to be the trusted partner in each district before they get there." What to be ready for Governments already run farmer registration as part of procurement, and a state could build its own booking system. Answer: you would rather work with agencies than compete with them, and you offer a ready-made, tested system. Right now these are plans. Say "we're building" instead of claiming

existing integrations or data. Your strongest point is a signed pilot with one agency, mandi or FPO. Even one letter of interest makes the moat real.

The Founder: Walk me through your first 90 days with this money. What gets done, in order?

"In the first 90 days, the goal is to prove the idea in one district with one crop. The order is: Days 1-30: Learn and prepare Interview 50-100 farmers and record their real wait times, payment delays and any extra payments they were asked for. Meet the local procurement agency, mandi or FPO to agree on a pilot and get written interest. Check with a lawyer or advisor whether we can charge a fee on an MSP sale in this state. Hire a part-time developer and 2 village-level field agents. Days 31-60: Build and test Build the first version: slot booking, turn tracking, sale-limit tracker and SMS or WhatsApp alerts, in the local language and designed to work on basic phones. Test with 20-30 farmers, fix problems, and get feedback. Start talks with one lending partner (NBFC or bank) for the future advance feature. We will not launch the advance yet. Days 61-90: Run the pilot Onboard the first 300-500 farmers through agents, FPOs and student volunteers from NSS and UBA. Track and report four numbers: farmers who booked a slot, average wait time, farmers who finished a sale, and how many came back. Use the results to decide the next district and the next step on the advance. How I'd spend about ₹18 lakh of the ₹50 lakh in this period Product and development: ₹6 lakh Field team and farmer incentives: ₹4 lakh Hiring and part-time support: ₹3 lakh Legal and compliance: ₹2 lakh Travel and operations: ₹2 lakh Buffer: ₹1 lakh The remaining ₹32 lakh is the runway to expand to more districts if the pilot works." Things to watch Procurement is seasonal. Time the live pilot to a buying season, such as wheat in spring, so you can test with real sales. The advance feature needs a lending partner and approvals, so it will take longer than 90 days. A pilot needs agency cooperation. Your success depends on getting that early, so lead with it.

The Customer: Why would your target customer switch to KisanSetu today, instead of what they already use?

"Today a farmer has two choices. They can queue at the procurement centre and wait their turn, or they can sell to a local buyer at a lower price because they need cash. Both are painful, and KisanSetu offers a better way. Time: Booking a slot means the farmer comes when their turn is confirmed, instead of waiting for days while work at home stops. Fairness: Turns are given in booking order and visible on the app, so there is no reason to pay to move up. Better price: The farmer who would have sold locally can reach the MSP, which is the whole point of the system. Low risk to try: Farmers don't pay to sign up. We charge only when a sale is completed, and we work with their existing registration and the agency's process, so they don't change how they farm. Cash later: Once the optional advance is live, a farmer can get money against a confirmed sale and won't have to take a lower local price just to pay for the next crop." What to be ready for The local buyer pays instantly. Be clear that the advance is a future feature and not live today. Until it exists, say your first pitch is about time and fairness, not cash. Trust and phone use. Many farmers prefer in-person help. This is why village agents, SMS or WhatsApp alerts and the local language are in your plan. Existing government portals. State registration systems already exist, so describe KisanSetu as working with them and fixing the gaps, not replacing them. Proof helps most. If any farmer you've spoken to said they'd switch, quote them with a number, such as "X out of Y farmers said they would book a slot."

The Angel Investor: When does KisanSetu break even, and how does my money come back to me?

"Our cost base is small, so break-even comes from reaching enough active farmers, not from spending a lot. Break-even After the pilot, I expect running costs of roughly ₹4 lakh a month, or about ₹48 lakh a year. That covers a small team, field agents, tools and compliance. Each active farmer brings us about ₹1,200 a year on average from the 0.5-1% fee on a ₹1 lakh sale and some farmers selling in more than one season. That means we break even at about 4,000 to 5,000 active farmers. This is two to four districts, and the licence fees from

agencies and FPOs lower that number further. Our timeline: the pilot in the first 90 days with 300-500 farmers, then more districts in the next season, with break-even in about 18 to 24 months. Revenue is seasonal, so cash will be uneven across the year, and the runway from this round is meant to cover that. How your money comes back You'd receive equity for your investment. For example, ₹50 lakh for 15% implies a valuation of about ₹3.3 crore after your investment. Returns would come from one of three routes: a later funding round at a higher valuation, an acquisition by an agri-tech, fintech or lending company that wants our farmer network and data, or a buyback or dividends once we are profitable. Here is an illustration of the upside: with 5 lakh active farmers at ₹1,200 each, revenue would be about ₹60 crore a year. This is a goal and not a prediction, and we will report progress each quarter so you can see how we are doing." Be upfront about the risk Early-stage startups often return nothing. Sharks respect it when you say this plainly and show the milestones that would reduce the risk. Your investor milestones could be: pilot done, agency agreement signed, advance partner signed, then the next district. The fee and the advance both need legal and partner approvals, so mention these as plans and don't promise them.